

Manuel Scionti

Applied AI Engineer | Forward-Deployed AI & Customer Engineering

Barcelona, Spain | Open to relocation across Europe | Italian native, English C1, Spanish C1
scionti.manuel@hotmail.it | LinkedIn | Portfolio | GitHub | Writing

Profile

Customer-facing Applied AI engineer with 3+ years owning enterprise work from pre-sales discovery and solution design through implementation, rollout, and post-sales. Senior consultant at Capitole, most recently embedded in ADP's Core AI Platform team through July 2026. Hands-on across production RAG, agentic systems, LLM evaluation, cloud infrastructure, and executive stakeholder communication.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, SQL

FDE / Infrastructure: FastAPI, Pydantic, Docker, REST APIs, AWS, Azure, Databricks, OpenSearch, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, observability

AI / Data: MCP, agentic workflows, production RAG, vector databases, LLM evals, golden datasets, hybrid search, reranking, LangGraph, Graph RAG, multimodal AI

Professional Experience

Senior Data Consultant | Applied AI & Client Delivery

Mar 2025 – Present

Capitole Consulting

Barcelona, Spain

Selected client engagement: ADP – AI Engineer, Core AI Platform Team

Mar 2025 – Jul 2026

- Embedded in ADP's core AI team, translating requirements from product, platform, domain SMEs, and consuming business units into production capabilities adopted by **5+ teams across 10+ BUs**, two regions, and four environments.
- Owned an offline FAQ-generation pipeline over a **5,000+ page** internal wiki, deployed for **20+ German-market enterprise clients**; chose batch generation to bound cost and latency and built an LLM-as-judge + SME release gate, reducing technical-support tickets by **35%**.
- Designed hybrid retrieval and reranking over a heterogeneous **15,000+ document** corpus; improved retrieval quality by **15%** on an SME-annotated golden set and aligned product and platform teams on confidence-based production gating.
- Standardised reusable delivery patterns and CI/CD, reducing new-use-case delivery from months to weeks and Jenkins build time by **25%**; led AI-coding-agent enablement for a 20-person engineering group.

AI Engineer | Founding AI Team & Customer-Facing Delivery

Nov 2023 – Mar 2025

Neodata Group – AI Consulting Startup

Catania, Italy

- Joined sales in first client conversations and led discovery, feasibility, scoping, and solution design for **20+ enterprise clients**; owned technical relationships through implementation, rollout, post-sales support, and roadmap discussions.
- Technical owner for Catania Airport's AI media-intelligence platform, meeting monthly with the **CFO and CTO** to translate business and security needs into roadmap, acceptance criteria, and executive demos; shipped an approved MVP over **50,000+ social interactions** and three years of press data.
- Led two junior engineers and delivered four AI projects from pilot to production, including multimodal retrieval over **1,000+ videos** for a major Italian broadcaster and personalised content systems deployed across **5+ museums**.
- Built an internal document-intelligence framework for tables and enterprise files, reducing extraction errors by **75%** versus open-source baselines and outperforming Azure Document Intelligence on structured specification tables.

Machine Learning Engineer | Embedded Client Delivery

Feb 2023 – Nov 2023

Koexai

Catania, Italy

- Worked directly with a single client to design and deliver AWS data and ML infrastructure (S3, Glue, Athena) and customer-segmentation models across **500+ customers**; automated recurring operations and reduced manual processing time by **80%**.

Leadership, Community & Recognition

- **Community Manager, Applied AI Engineers** – run member onboarding, technical discussions, and weekly Q&A for an international community focused on Applied AI and FDE careers.
- **Technical Lead & Organiser, Neodata GenAI Hackathons** – designed challenges and taught hands-on workshops on RAG, LLMs, agents, and multi-agent systems across two editions at the University of Catania.
- **IBM x Datapizza GenAI Hackathon, 2025** – top 10% of 600+ applicants; built a Graph RAG and multi-agent document-intelligence system.
- **Open-source contributor** – three PRs merged into IBM Agentics, including a production bug fix in the Pydantic/VLLM integration.

Education

M.Sc. Data Science, University of Catania – 110/110 summa cum laude

2021 – 2023

Erasmus+ in Artificial Intelligence, Goethe University Frankfurt

2023

B.Sc. Business Management, University of Catania – 100/110

2016 – 2020